

alone many evenings. She also found herself snapping at Randy when he would call to say he would be home at 7, and then he'd show up at 10 or 11.

When the baby came, Randy actually took on more work and more hours. Julie assumed he did so because he didn't want to be bothered with her or the child.

In reality, Randy's compulsion for work was a fear of failure. He had grown up wearing church people's hand-me-downs and making excuses for the fact that he had to work when other kids played sports. So his adult life consisted of overworking to accumulate a buffer against poverty. The baby simply represented one more need to work harder. As their marriage relationship deteriorated, Randy began to panic. He was doing what he thought was the best thing to do, and Julie just got more resentful.

Randy asked his pastor to help, and he and Julie began counseling sessions at least once a month. But as the marriage strain began to ease a little, Randy stepped right back into his workaholic mold and Julie regressed to her nagging wife mold. Their marriage began another decline even during the counseling, and Randy withdrew to his work to escape.

A business associate noticed Randy's change in demeanor and asked what the problem was. This friend then asked Randy a question he had not been asked before: "Randy, have you ever accepted Jesus Christ as your Saviour?" Randy explained that he had grown up in a Christian home and was baptized at an early age. "But Randy," the friend said, "have you ever accepted Christ as *your* Saviour?" When Randy said he wasn't really sure, the friend asked, "Would you like to make sure?" Randy accepted Christ that day.

Randy's friend had recognized that Randy's overcommitment to work and worry about security had to be either a lack of spiritual maturity or a lack of salvation. As Psalms 127:2 says, "It is vain for you to rise up early, to retire late, to eat the bread of painful labors; for He gives to His beloved even in his sleep."

Randy's life took a dramatic turn from that point on. He still